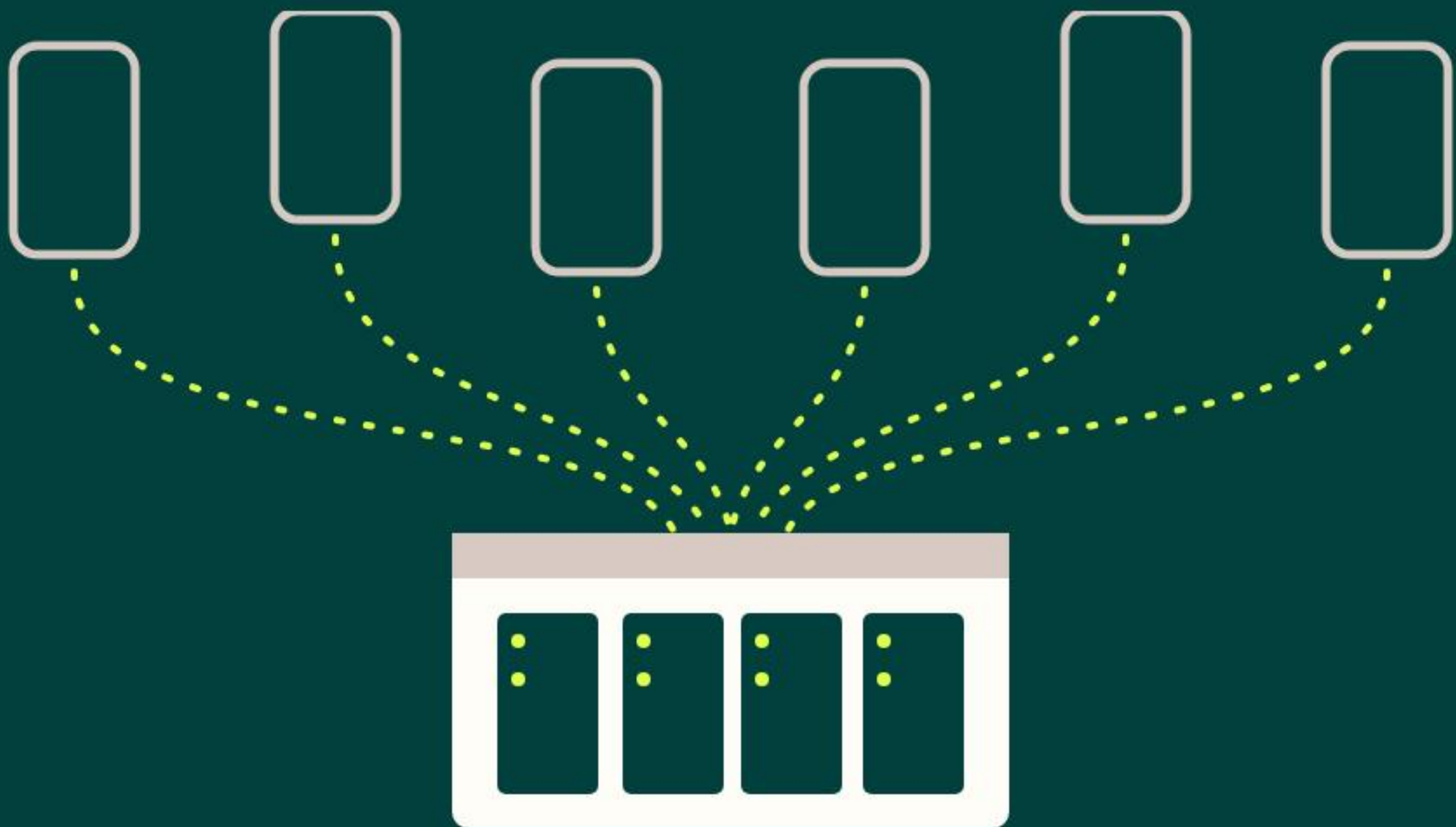


958 million Indians
are online.

*Their data
needs a home.*



Source: IAMAI-Kantar, *Internet in India Report 2025* (958 million active internet users).

Why is India building *so many data centres?*

Five forces are driving the boom.

01 More people online

02 Everyday life went digital

03 Rules to keep data in India

04 The AI race

05 Cables that land on our coasts

More people *online.*

958_M active internet
users in 2025

57% rural

43% urban

Most new users now come from **rural India**, and each one adds to the data the country stores and serves.

Room to grow: about 579 million Indians are still not active online, so demand will keep rising.

Source: IAMA-Kantar, *Internet in India Report 2025*.

Everyday life *went digital.*

₹

24_{bn}

UPI transactions in one
month (Sept 2026)



588_M

Indians watch short-
video content

Payments, video, shopping and government services all
run in data centres.

Sources: NPCI (Sept 2026: 24.07 bn); IAMAI-Kantar, *Internet in India Report 2025*.

Rules to keep *data close to home.*

○ 2018

RBI requires payment-system data to be stored only in India.

○ 2023

The Digital Personal Data Protection Act sets national rules for handling and transferring personal data.

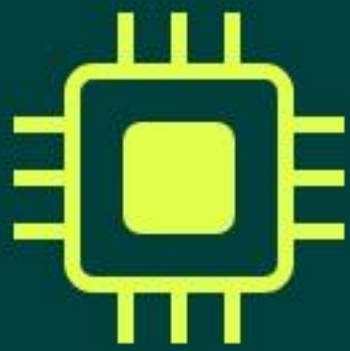
○ 2025 → 2027

The DPDP Rules phase in, and companies plan where their data will live.

The result: more data stored and processed inside India, which means more local data centres.

The *AI race*.

AI needs specialised chips that run hot and draw far more power than everyday servers.



₹10,372 cr

IndiaAI Mission (2024), including shared AI computing capacity

Globally, the IEA names AI as the **biggest driver** of data centre electricity growth to 2030.

More AI means more computing, and more electricity. Clean power matters more than ever.

Sources: Government of India, IndiaAI Mission (approved 2024); IEA, *Energy and AI* (2025).

Cables that land *on our coasts.*



Undersea internet cables land in coastal cities. That's a big reason Mumbai and Chennai host **nearly three-quarters** of India's data centre capacity.

Source: CBRE (Mumbai 53%, Chennai 20% of operational capacity, Sept 2025).

**Buildings going up today
will run for decades.**
***Build them green
from day one.***

✓ **Contract clean power from the start**

✓ **Design for efficient, low-water
cooling**

✓ **Plan for hardware reuse and
recycling**

— THE TAKEAWAY

India's data boom
is just beginning.
*So is the chance
to build it right.*

NEXT IN THIS SERIES

Where do old servers go?

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